The division plan, as inherited by Kaul, was as follows: 62 Brigade was to guard the frontal approach to Se-la at all costs; Se-la depth and the area around Dirang Dzong was to be the responsibility of 65 Brigade; and the corps's vital ground was to be Bomdila, to be defended by 48 Brigade. While 62 Brigade was mainly being supplied by air with the IAF dropping between 60 to 90 tons at the Senge DZ daily, a fleet of 1-ton vehicles was maintaining 65 and 48 Brigade.

Brigadier Hoshiar Singh, who was now commanding 62 Brigade, exhibited a steely resolve that indicated to the troops that come what may, he was going to dig in and fight it out at Se-la. On arrival, he had declared Se-la to be an impregnable natural fortress. A solid soldier, he went about his job methodically despite all the drawbacks. Over the next two weeks, the battalions worked round the clock, constructing bunkers. Since corrugated galvanized iron sheets were not available, wooden beams were used with shrub branches for overhead cover. Where the ground was frozen solid, stone sangars were constructed. By 15 November, almost all units had completed their defences. However, only a part of the available anti-personnel mines had been laid.

Though the bulk of the guns had been abandoned across the Tawang Chu during the withdrawal, 5 Field Regiment less two batteries under the command of Lieutenant Colonel Budhwar, equipped with 25-pounder guns, had taken charge since his arrival on 27 October. 87 Field Battery under Major Brahm Sat, also armed with 25-pounders, C Troop 34 Heavy Mortar Battery with 4.2-inch mortars and 2 Derajat Mountain Battery minus a section with their 3.7-inch howitzers were also brought under Budhwar. A platoon of 7 Mahar equipped with Vickers MMGs was attached to 2 Sikh LI with one section covering the Kye-la and the other section covering the main road to Nuranang. By 14 November, 5 Field's own 96 Battery had also joined its parent group. However, at this point, 4 Infantry Division had only two-thirds of its projected requirement of seventeen infantry battalions, a third of the required field artillery and a quarter of the required mountain guns and heavy mortars.

Pooled transport was being used to ferry supplies to the battalions from the Senge DZ. Even though all units were deficient in rifles, grenades, 2-inch mortar bombs and had no mortar flares, they had stocked up to two scales of front line small arms ammunition and one week's unbalanced rations.